The Peppered Moth: An Example of natural selection

In England there is a type of moth called the peppered moth. It is a light creamy coloured moth with darker patches. It lives on trees and was camouflaged by the lichen growing on the tree trunks.

In 1848, the first **black** peppered moth was seen in the Manchester area of England.

At that time, the industrial revolution was happening and Manchester was a big industrial town. The sulphur dioxide that was produced from the burning of coal killed all the lichen on the trees so the trees appeared darker.

The creamy coloured peppered moth was no longer camouflaged but the black moth was well hidden on the dark tree trunks.

By 1895, 95% of the peppered moth population in the Manchester area was black.

Questions

1. What are the varieties of colour in the peppered moth species?

2. Which moth is camouflaged better in the unpolluted wood?

3. What is the advantage to the moth of camouflage?

4. Why did the trees become darker?

5. What happened to the light variety of moths as the trees became darker?

6. What happened to the dark variety of moths as the trees became darker?

7. What happened to the overall appearance of the moth species?

8. What do we call this change?